Object Oriented Programming (CSEG1044)

Unit 03 – Lecture 01: Nested Classes (Types + Use-cases)

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Sources: Schildt, *Java: The Complete Reference* (12e) (nested/inner classes, exceptions, threads, I/O).; Oracle Java Tutorials: Nested Classes + Exceptions + Concurrency + Basic I/O (accessed February 27, 2026).; Java SE API docs (e.g., `Thread`, `AutoCloseable`) (accessed February 27, 2026).

Quick Links

Overview Key Topics Demo Summary

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Agenda

1 Overview

2 Key Topics

3 Demo / Example

4 Summary

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Learning Outcomes

- Explain why nested classes improve encapsulation in some designs.

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Learning Outcomes

- Explain why nested classes improve encapsulation in some designs.
- Differentiate static nested, inner, local, and anonymous classes.

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Learning Outcomes

- Explain why nested classes improve encapsulation in some designs.
- Differentiate static nested, inner, local, and anonymous classes.
- Recognize use cases: helpers and callbacks/listeners (Swing later).

Sources: Schildt, *Java: The Complete Reference* (12e) (nested/inner classes, exceptions, threads, I/O).; Oracle Java Tutorials: Nested Classes + Exceptions + Concurrency + Basic I/O (accessed February 27, 2026).; Java SE API docs (e.g., `Thread`, `AutoCloseable`) (accessed February 27, 2026).

Unit 03: Nested Classes, Exceptions, Multithreading & IO Streams

- Lecture focus: Nested Classes (Types + Use-cases)

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Today: Roadmap

- Nested class motivation: scope and encapsulation

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Today: Roadmap

- Nested class motivation: scope and encapsulation
- Static nested, inner, local, and anonymous classes

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Today: Roadmap

- Nested class motivation: scope and encapsulation
- Static nested, inner, local, and anonymous classes
- Use-cases: helpers, callbacks/listeners (bridge to Swing later)

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Why nested classes?

- Keep helper types close to the code that uses them.

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- Reduce public API surface (better encapsulation).

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Why nested classes?

- Keep helper types close to the code that uses them.
- Reduce public API surface (better encapsulation).
- Common for callbacks/listeners.

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Types (quick)

- **Static nested**: no outer instance reference.

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Types (quick)

- **Static nested**: no outer instance reference.
- **Inner**: has implicit outer instance reference.

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Types (quick)

- **Static nested**: no outer instance reference.
- **Inner**: has implicit outer instance reference.
- **Local**: declared inside a method; limited scope.

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Types (quick)

- **Static nested**: no outer instance reference.
- **Inner**: has implicit outer instance reference.
- **Local**: declared inside a method; limited scope.
- **Anonymous**: unnamed; used inline for one-time behavior.

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Static nested vs inner (key difference)

- **Static nested**: behaves like a normal class scoped inside outer; no outer object needed.

Rule: if you do not need outer state, prefer `static`.

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Static nested vs inner (key difference)

- **Static nested**: behaves like a normal class scoped inside outer; no outer object needed.
- **Inner**: every instance is tied to an outer object (has an implicit outer reference).

Rule: if you do not need outer state, prefer `static`.

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Example: static nested helper (validator)

```
class BankAccount {
  static class Validator {
    static void requirePositive(double amt) {
      if (amt <= 0) throw new IllegalArgumentException("amt
          ");
    }
  }

  void deposit(double amt) {
    Validator.requirePositive(amt);
    // ... update balance
  }
}
```

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Example: local class (inside a method)

```
public void demoLocal() {
  final int times = 2; // effectively final

  class Printer {
    void say(String msg) {
      for (int i = 0; i < times; i++)
        System.out.println(msg);
    }
  }

  new Printer().say("Hi");
}
```

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Use cases

- Helpers: validators, builders, entries/tuples

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Use cases

- Helpers: validators, builders, entries/tuples
- Iterators and small adapters

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Use cases

- Helpers: validators, builders, entries/tuples
- Iterators and small adapters
- Callbacks/listeners (Swing event handling later)

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Example: inner + anonymous (small) (1/2)

```
interface Greeter { void greet(String name); }

public class Outer {
    private final String prefix = "Hello";

    class InnerGreeter implements Greeter {
        public void greet(String name) {
            System.out.println(prefix + ", " + name);
        }
    }
```

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Example: inner + anonymous (small) (2/2)

```
// continued...
    public void demo() {
        Greeter a = new InnerGreeter();
        Greeter b = new Greeter() { // anonymous
            public void greet(String name) {
                System.out.println(prefix + " (anon), " +
                    name);
            }
        };
        a.greet("UPES");
        b.greet("UPES");
    }
}
```

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Mini Exercises (2–3 mins)

1. Which type has an implicit outer reference?

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Mini Exercises (2–3 mins)

1. Which type has an implicit outer reference?
2. Which type is commonly used for callbacks?

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Mini Exercises (2–3 mins)

1. Which type has an implicit outer reference?
2. Which type is commonly used for callbacks?
3. What does "effectively final" mean for local classes?

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Key Takeaways

- Nested classes improve encapsulation and keep helpers local.

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Key Takeaways

- Nested classes improve encapsulation and keep helpers local.
- Know the 4 kinds: static nested, inner, local, anonymous.

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Key Takeaways

- Nested classes improve encapsulation and keep helpers local.
- Know the 4 kinds: static nested, inner, local, anonymous.
- Anonymous classes are common for callback-style code (Swing).

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Checkpoint Questions

1. Difference: static nested vs inner class?

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Checkpoint Questions

1. Difference: static nested vs inner class?
2. Why are anonymous classes used in event handling?

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Checkpoint Questions

1. Difference: static nested vs inner class?
2. Why are anonymous classes used in event handling?
3. Where can a local class be used?

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Next Lecture Preview

Next: Exception Handling (Core)

- We will handle errors safely using `try/catch/finally` and custom exceptions.

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